FOODEASE

User Research & Persona Development

WEEK 1 • ADVANCED UX RESEARCH REPORT

Digital Product: FoodEase — a mobile-first food discovery and delivery experience

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Date: 29 August 2026

Research approach	Deliverable scope
Secondary research + simulated survey + segmentation + persona synthesis	Background, methodology, findings, 3 personas, journey insights, design implications

Important methodology note: Participant percentages in the survey section are simulated/hypothetical and are included for UX research practice. External research findings are separately identified and referenced.

Executive Summary

FoodEase is a hypothetical mobile food-ordering product created to demonstrate a user-centered research process. The research focuses on how users discover restaurants, compare options, evaluate value, place orders, track deliveries, and resolve problems.

The evidence base combines secondary research with a clearly labelled simulated survey of 30 participants. Recent academic literature identifies convenience, perceived value, ease of use, trust, price-saving orientation, food quality, delivery speed, ratings/reviews and app functionality as important factors in online food-delivery usage. A 2026 Bengaluru study similarly reports food quality and delivery speed among the strongest decision drivers. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search1■turn0search2■

The simulated findings point to three practical segments: budget-conscious students, time-sensitive working professionals, and reliability-focused family users. Although these groups share a need for trustworthy and simple ordering, their priorities differ: students emphasize value, professionals emphasize speed and predictability, while family users emphasize accuracy, customization and dependable support.

Research output	Result
Research participants (simulation)	30 hypothetical respondents
Core segments	3 primary segments
Personas	3 detailed personas
Major themes	Value, speed, trust, quality, control
Primary design opportunity	Make the total cost, ETA, food quality signals and issue resolution highly transparent

1. Product Background

1.1 Product concept

FoodEase is a mobile-first food discovery and ordering platform. It brings restaurant discovery, menu comparison, personalization, ordering, live delivery tracking and post-order support into one coherent experience.

> The product is intentionally designed as a research case study rather than a claim about an existing commercial product. The research question is: **How might we reduce uncertainty and effort at every stage of the food-ordering journey?**

1.2 Problem statement

Users often open food-delivery apps with a simple goal—find something suitable and order it quickly—but the journey can become cognitively expensive. They may compare prices, offers, ratings, delivery estimates, restaurant availability and menu options before deciding. Research also identifies issues around tracking accuracy, customer service, food condition and online/offline consistency.
■cite■turn0search3■turn0search12■

1.3 Product goals

• Reduce the number of decisions required to place a confident order.

• Make price, delivery time and food-quality signals easy to compare.

• Create a predictable and trustworthy tracking experience.

• Support quick reordering and personalization without creating clutter.

• Make problem resolution visible, fast and understandable.

1.4 Target audience

Segment	Typical context	Primary objective
Students	Limited budget, frequent mobile use, social/peer influence	Good food at the lowest acceptable total cost
Working professionals	Busy schedules, lunch/dinner time pressure	Reliable food with predictable ETA
Family users	Multiple people, varied preferences, larger baskets	Accurate, customizable and dependable order

2. Research Methodology

2.1 Research objectives

• Understand why people choose online food delivery instead of other ordering methods.

• Identify the functional and emotional needs that influence restaurant selection.

• Map recurring frustrations across discovery, checkout, delivery and support.

• Identify meaningful user segments based on goals, constraints and behavior.

• Translate findings into personas that can guide interface and feature decisions.

2.2 Research methods

Method	Purpose	Evidence used
Secondary research	Ground the study in existing research	Academic studies on online food delivery adoption, reviews, usage and Indian consumer behavior
Simulated survey	Practice quantitative synthesis	30 hypothetical respondents; age, frequency, spending, priorities and pain points
Competitive observation	Identify common interaction patterns	Generic category patterns: search, filters, offers, cart, checkout, tracking, support
Persona synthesis	Turn patterns into actionable archetypes	Goals, behaviors, motivations, frustrations, needs and scenarios

2.3 Research limitations

• The survey dataset is simulated for the assignment and must not be presented as real primary research.

• A production UX study would require recruitment screening, consent, interview recordings/notes, validated survey questions and statistical analysis.

• Personas are evidence-informed archetypes, not descriptions of individual real people.

• Further research should test accessibility, dietary requirements, payment behavior, location-specific delivery constraints and trust/security concerns.

3. Background Research & Evidence

3.1 What existing research suggests

A 2024 meta-analysis of online food-delivery research found that performance expectancy, effort expectancy, social influence, facilitating conditions and perceived risk influence perceived value, while perceived value is associated with usage, satisfaction, trust and loyalty. ■cite■turn0search0■

Another 2024 meta-analytic study reviewed 60 studies with 61 independent samples (N=25,390) and found meaningful relationships among convenience, price-saving orientation, ease of use, usefulness, trust and intention to use food-delivery services. ■cite■turn0search2■

Indian research is especially relevant to this case. A study of consumers in Karnataka reported that convenience, food quality, food availability, restaurant reviews, offers/discounts, faster delivery and restaurant choice contributed to satisfaction. ■cite■turn0search4■turn0search8■

A 2026 Bengaluru study using 500 consumers and 100 restaurants reported that 76% of surveyed consumers ordered online at least weekly, with food quality and delivery speed ranking as strong decision drivers. This provides useful contextual support for focusing FoodEase on quality signals and predictable delivery.

■cite■turn0search1■

Research on Indian restaurant reviews also shows that delivery-related themes appear strongly in customer reviews, demonstrating that the delivery experience is part of how users evaluate the overall service. ■cite■turn0search3■

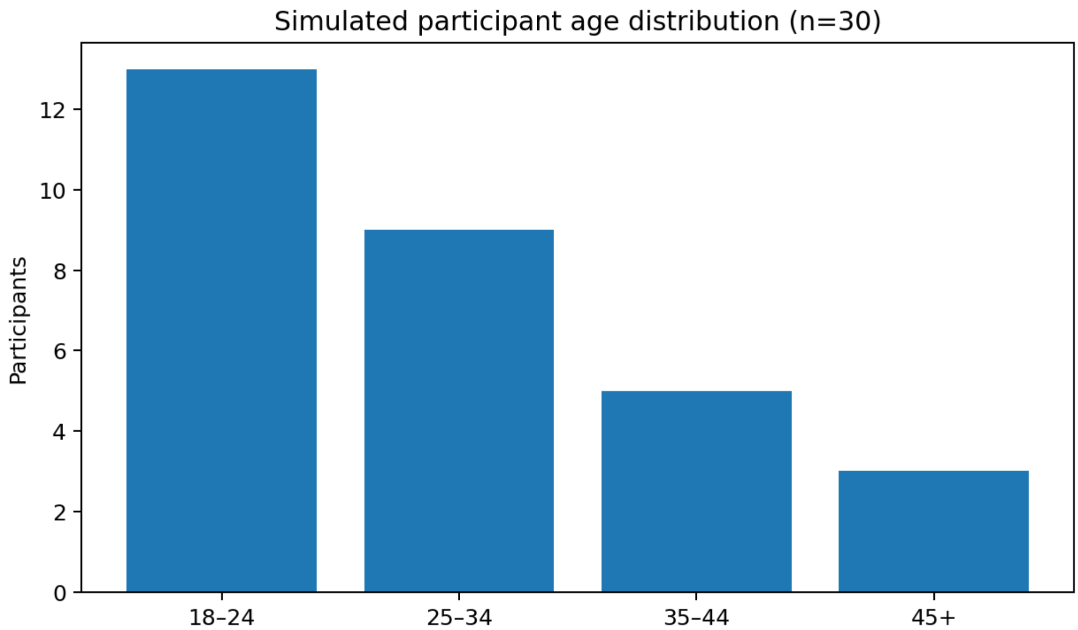
3.2 Evidence-to-design translation

Evidence theme	UX implication for FoodEase
Convenience & ease	Short checkout, smart defaults, repeat order and clear information hierarchy
Price-saving orientation	Show total payable amount early; explain fees and offers instead of hiding them
Trust & perceived risk	Verified ratings, transparent restaurant information, secure payment cues and clear issue handling
Food quality	Photos, recent reviews, item-level ratings and restaurant quality indicators
Delivery speed	Prominent ETA, confidence range and proactive delay communication
Tracking & support	Accurate status states, accessible help and clear resolution paths

4. Simulated Research Study

4.1 Sample profile

For the assignment simulation, 30 hypothetical participants were created to represent a diverse mix of students, professionals and family decision-makers. The dataset is intentionally illustrative and is not presented as actual fieldwork.



4.2 Simulated survey questions

• How often do you order food online?

• What is your typical order value?

• What matters most when choosing a restaurant?

• What is the biggest frustration you experience?

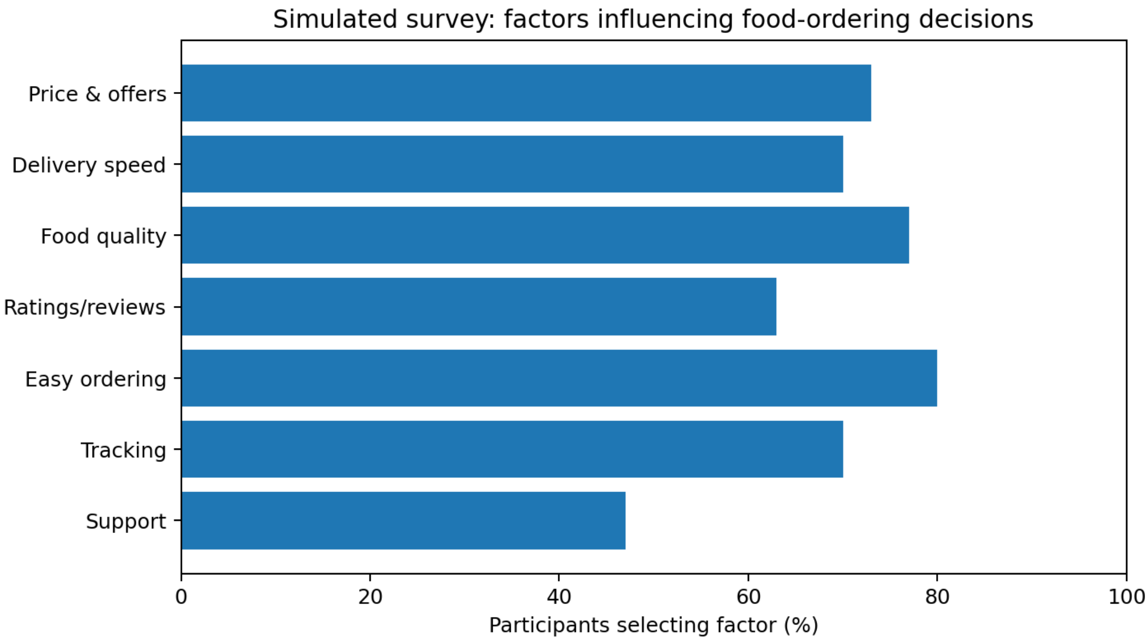
• How important are ratings and reviews?

• How important is knowing the final price before checkout?

• What would make you reorder from the same restaurant?

• How satisfied are you with delivery tracking?

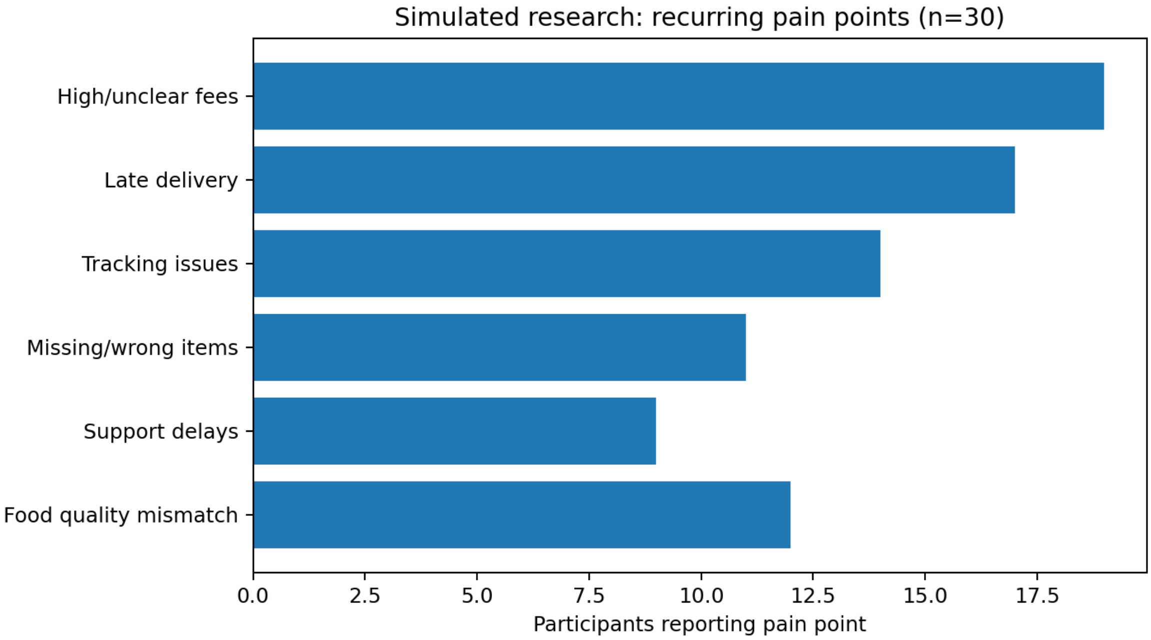
4.3 Simulated quantitative findings



The simulated results prioritize ease of ordering, food quality, price/offer transparency, delivery speed and tracking. These patterns are directionally consistent with themes found in published food-delivery research, but the simulated percentages themselves are assignment data. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search1■

5. Pain Points & Behavioral Themes

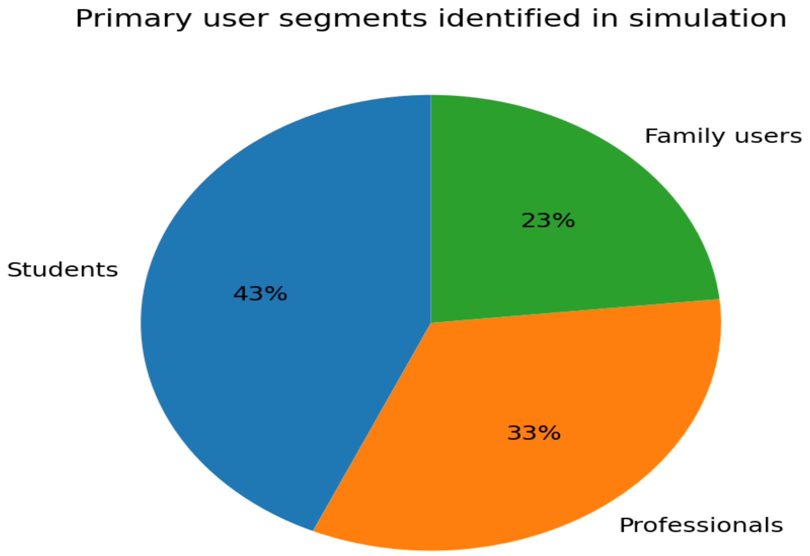
5.1 Recurring pain points



5.2 Thematic analysis

Theme	Observed behavior	Underlying need
Value uncertainty	Users compare offers but may discover extra fees late	Price transparency and confidence
Time pressure	Professionals decide quickly during work breaks	Fast scanning and predictable ETA
Trust gap	Users rely on ratings, photos and recent reviews	Credible quality signals
Delivery anxiety	Users repeatedly check order status	Accurate tracking and proactive alerts
Order complexity	Families customize multiple items	Easy variant selection and basket control
Recovery frustration	Users struggle when items are missing or wrong	Fast, visible and fair support flow

6. User Segmentation



The simulated sample was segmented using **behavioral context** rather than age alone. This is important because two people of the same age may have very different goals when ordering food.

Segment	Behavioral signature	Design priority
Budget Navigator	Checks offers, compares totals, orders socially and often	Savings, transparent fees, quick comparisons
Time Optimizer	Orders during busy periods and values predictability	Speed, ETA confidence, repeat order
Household Coordinator	Manages multi-person orders and preferences	Customization, basket clarity, reliable support

Segmentation insight: FoodEase should avoid a one-size-fits-all home screen. Personalization should change the emphasis of recommendations—for example, showing value-first collections to Budget Navigators and fast/reliable options to Time Optimizers.

7.1 Persona — Ananya Rao

Ananya Rao

20 • College Student • Budget Navigator

Persona type
Primary target archetype

Research confidence
Medium — synthesized from simulated patterns + secondary research

> “I want something tasty and affordable, but I don't want to discover extra charges at the last step.”

Brief biography

Ananya is a college student who frequently orders food with friends after classes or while studying. She is comfortable with mobile apps and enjoys discovering new restaurants, but she is highly sensitive to the final price. She often opens several restaurants, checks ratings, compares offers and then abandons the cart if the deal does not feel worthwhile.

Demographics & context

Attribute	Profile
Age	20
Occupation	Undergraduate student
Ordering frequency	2–4 times per week
Typical order	■200–■500
Device	Android smartphone
Context	Hostel/home/study sessions
Decision style	Comparison-heavy, value-driven

Goals & motivations

• Find an acceptable meal quickly within a limited budget.

• Discover good-rated restaurants without spending too much time searching.

• Discounts that genuinely reduce the total price.

• Peer recommendations and visible ratings.

• Feeling that the final price is fair.

Pain points

• Delivery fees or platform charges appearing late.

• Confusing offer conditions.

• Too many nearly identical restaurant choices.

• Poor quality despite attractive photos.

Behaviors

- Searches by cuisine and price.
- Sorts by rating and delivery time.
- Shares restaurant links with friends.
- Reorders familiar items when the price is predictable.

Key needs

- Up-front total cost.
- Simple offer explanations.
- Strong rating/review signals.
- Budget filters and smart recommendations.

Representative scenario

Ananya is studying with two friends at 8:30 PM. She searches for meals under ■300 per person, applies a budget filter, checks recent reviews and sees the exact payable total before opening checkout. She completes the order in under two minutes.

Design implications

- Show total price early, not only at checkout.
- Use concise offer labels such as “■80 saved” with expandable conditions.
- Provide budget-first filters and collections.
- Highlight recent reviews and item-level ratings.

7.2 Persona — Rahul Mehta

Rahul Mehta

28 • Software Professional • Time Optimizer

Persona type
Primary target archetype

Research confidence
Medium — synthesized from simulated patterns + secondary research

“If the app says 30 minutes, I need to trust that estimate.”

Brief biography

Rahul works long hours and frequently orders lunch or dinner between meetings. He is willing to pay slightly more for reliability. His biggest frustration is not price—it is uncertainty. He wants a fast decision, a credible ETA and proactive communication if the order is delayed.

Demographics & context

Attribute	Profile
Age	28
Occupation	Software professional
Ordering frequency	3–5 times per week
Typical order	■350–■800
Device	Android/iOS smartphone
Context	Office/home, often during work
Decision style	Speed and reliability first

Goals & motivations

- Place an order with minimal cognitive effort.
- Receive food within a predictable time window.
- Reliable restaurants.
- Accurate ETAs.
- One-tap repeat ordering.
- Low-friction payment.

Pain points

- Inaccurate delivery tracking.
- Unexpected delays.
- Too many checkout steps.
- Needing to repeatedly contact support.

Behaviors

• Orders during lunch and late evenings.

• Uses reorder/history.

• Chooses highly rated restaurants with dependable ETAs.

• Checks tracking when approaching the promised time.

Key needs

• ETA confidence rather than a single optimistic number.

• One-tap reorder.

• Proactive delay alerts.

• Fast support escalation.

Representative scenario

Rahul has a 20-minute lunch break between meetings. FoodEase recommends restaurants with high ETA reliability, lets him repeat his previous lunch and confirms the total plus delivery window before payment.

Design implications

• Prioritize ETA and reliability on restaurant cards.

• Offer one-tap reorder from order history.

• Use meaningful tracking states rather than vague animations.

• Trigger proactive alerts before the promised time is missed.

7.3 Persona — Priya Sharma

Priya Sharma

38 • Working Parent • Household Coordinator

Persona type
Primary target archetype

Research confidence
Medium — synthesized from simulated patterns + secondary research

> “When I order for everyone, accuracy matters more than another discount.”

Brief biography

Priya often coordinates dinner for her household. Her orders contain multiple items with different preferences, sizes or add-ons. She values dependable restaurants, clear customization and easy problem resolution. She is less interested in exploring dozens of options and more interested in getting the right order delivered correctly.

Demographics & context

Attribute	Profile
Age	38
Occupation	Working professional / parent
Ordering frequency	1–3 times per week
Typical order	■700–■1,500
Device	Android smartphone
Context	Home/family meals
Decision style	Reliability and accuracy

Goals & motivations

- Build a multi-person order without mistakes.
- Customize meals clearly and verify the basket before payment.
- Accurate item customization.
- Food quality and hygiene signals.
- Reliable delivery.
- Accessible support.

Pain points

- Missing or incorrect items.
- Unclear customization.
- Difficult refund/replacement processes.
- Poor restaurant information.

Behaviors

• Adds several items at once.

• Reads reviews before choosing family restaurants.

• Checks the basket carefully.

• Prefers familiar restaurants after a good experience.

Key needs

• Clear item-level customization.

• Basket verification.

• Family-friendly reordering.

• Simple issue reporting with photo/evidence support.

Representative scenario

Priya needs dinner for four people. FoodEase groups the basket by person, makes every customization visible and provides a final “order accuracy check” before payment. After delivery, she can report a missing item from the order timeline without searching through menus.

Design implications

• Use strong basket summaries and customization chips.

• Provide an order review checkpoint before payment.

• Allow fast reordering of complete past baskets.

• Make missing-item and wrong-item support actions one or two taps away.

10. Persona Comparison & Cross-Persona Insights

Dimension	Ananya	Rahul	Priya
Primary goal	Affordable choice	Fast & predictable order	Accurate family meal
Top motivator	Savings	Reliability	Quality & control
Main frustration	Hidden/unclear costs	Late/inaccurate ETA	Missing/wrong items
Decision style	Compare	Decide quickly	Verify carefully
Most valuable feature	Budget discovery	Repeat + reliable ETA	Basket/customization control

Shared needs

• Trustworthy information before payment.

• Low cognitive load and clear navigation.

• Accurate restaurant/menu information.

• Transparent pricing and delivery expectations.

• Fast recovery when something goes wrong.

Differences that should shape personalization

• Students benefit from value-oriented recommendations and social discovery.

• Professionals benefit from reliability scores, ETA confidence and fast reorder flows.

• Family users benefit from customization, basket organization and issue-resolution shortcuts.

11. User Journey Map

The journey map below identifies moments where user confidence can increase or decrease. These moments become direct opportunities for interface design.

Stage	User action	Emotion / concern	Opportunity
Discover	Searches cuisine, restaurant or dish	Curious but overwhelmed	Personalized categories, concise filters
Compare	Checks price, rating, ETA and reviews	Uncertain	Comparable restaurant cards and trustworthy signals
Customize	Chooses size, add-ons, preferences	Concerned about mistakes	Clear selection states and item summaries
Checkout	Reviews total and pays	Price-sensitive	Full total before commitment
Track	Monitors preparation and delivery	Anxious near ETA	Accurate states, ETA confidence and alerts
Receive	Checks food and order accuracy	Satisfied or disappointed	Easy missing/wrong item reporting
Return	Rates or reorders	Loyal if experience was reliable	Smart reorder and useful feedback loop

Critical moment: **Checkout** → **Tracking**. This is where the product's promise becomes a real-world service. If the ETA is inaccurate or the price changes unexpectedly, trust falls rapidly.

12. UX Requirements Derived from Research

Priority	Requirement	Persona rationale
P0	Show final payable price before payment	All; especially Ananya
P0	Show ETA with confidence/reliability context	Rahul; also all users
P0	Provide clear order-status states and proactive delay communication	Rahul and Priya
P0	Make support actions visible from the order timeline	Priya and all users
P1	Add budget, delivery-time and rating filters	Ananya
P1	Enable one-tap reorder	Rahul
P1	Support structured multi-item customization	Priya
P2	Personalize home recommendations by behavioral goal	All segments

12.1 Information architecture recommendation

Home → Search → Restaurant → Item customization → Cart → Checkout → Live order → Order history → Support / Reorder

12.2 Key interface principles

• Clarity before persuasion: users should understand cost, ETA and conditions before seeing promotional content.

• Progressive disclosure: show essential information first, with detailed reviews and terms available on demand.

• Consistency: the same price, item name, customization and status should appear across restaurant, cart, checkout and tracking.

• Error prevention: validate stock, customization and address information before payment.

• Recovery by design: every order should provide a clear path to report problems.

13. Future Validation Plan

The personas and requirements should be treated as hypotheses. A real product team would validate them through iterative research and usability testing.

Research activity	Sample	Key question	Success signal
Moderated interviews	8–12 users	What creates trust or frustration?	Recurring themes across segments
Usability testing	5 users/round	Can users compare, order and track?	Task completion + low error rate
Prototype A/B test	30–60 users	Which restaurant card supports faster decisions?	Faster decision time without lower confidence
Survey	100+ users	Which needs are most common?	Reliable segment-level patterns
Analytics after launch	Real users	Where do users drop off?	Improved conversion and repeat rate

Recommended metrics

• Search-to-restaurant click-through rate.

• Restaurant-to-cart conversion.

• Checkout completion rate.

• Order tracking engagement and support contact rate.

• Repeat-order rate.

• Refund/problem-resolution time.

• User-reported confidence and satisfaction.

14. Conclusion

This Week 1 study demonstrates how user research can move from a broad product idea to evidence-informed design direction. The FoodEase case identifies three distinct user archetypes—Budget Navigator, Time Optimizer and Household Coordinator—whose needs overlap around trust and simplicity but diverge in value, speed and control.

The strongest design opportunity is not simply to add more features. It is to reduce uncertainty: make the total cost understandable, make delivery expectations credible, make food-quality signals useful, and make problem resolution visible. These priorities align with published research emphasizing convenience, perceived value, trust, food quality, delivery speed and app functionality in online food-delivery experiences. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search1■turn0search6■

For the next UX phase, the personas should guide information architecture and wireframes, while interviews and usability testing should validate whether the proposed priorities accurately reflect real users. In this way, the project follows a user-centered design loop: **Research → Synthesize → Define → Design → Test → Iterate.**

15. References

The following sources informed the background research. Simulated survey percentages in this report are separate from these external sources.

1. Why do consumers choose online food delivery services? A meta-analytic review. *International Journal of Hospitality Management*, 2024. ■cite■turn0search0■

2. Chiu, W., Badu-Baiden, F., & Cho, H. Consumers' intention to use online food delivery services: A meta-analytic structural equation modeling approach. *International Journal of Consumer Studies*, 2024. ■cite■turn0search2■

3. Pattanshetty, S., & Murthy, S. B. V. Influence of Consumer Ordering Behaviour on Restaurant Performance through Online Food Delivery Platforms: A Study of Bengaluru City, 2026. ■cite■turn0search1■

4. Vinish P., Pinto, P., Hawaldar, I. T., & Pinto, S. Antecedents of Behavioral Intention to Use Online Food Delivery Services: An Empirical Investigation. *Innovative Marketing*, 2021. ■cite■turn0search4■turn0search8■

5. Khan, Y. et al. Analysing customers' reviews and ratings for online food deliveries: A text mining approach. *International Journal of Consumer Studies*, 2023. ■cite■turn0search3■

6. Shirolkar, S., & Patil, K. Online Food Delivery Applications: Qualitative Inquiry of Dimensions Impacting Consumer Intentions and Usage, 2025. ■cite■turn0search6■

Appendix A — Research ethics & transparency

This academic UX exercise uses simulated participant data to demonstrate research synthesis. No real participant identities, private information or fabricated quotations are presented as real evidence. The personas are fictional archetypes created from the simulated dataset and published research themes.

Appendix B — Suggested presentation of this work

• Use this PDF as the written submission.

• If a presentation is required later, convert the major sections into 10–12 slides: problem, research method, findings, segments, three personas, journey map, requirements and conclusion.

• For the next week, use these personas as the basis for user flows, information architecture and wireframes.